

Chapter 11: Ancient India and the World

Textbook Exercise Solutions & Answers

1. Name the following:

Q1.) Places where articles made in Rome were found.

Kolhapur (Maharashtra) and Arikamedu (near Puducherry / Tamil Nadu).

Q2.) A new style of art emerged during the Kushana period in India.

Gandhara style of art (Gandhara School of Art).

Q3.) The language of the books Mahavamsa and Dipavamsa.

Pali language.

Q4.) A country to which Buddhism had spread in the ancient period.

Sri Lanka (as well as China, Myanmar, Thailand, and Indonesia).

2. Think and expand/elaborate:

Q1.) Indian culture had an impact on Southeast Asia.

1. Through trade and maritime links, Indian culture profoundly influenced the art, architecture, and religious traditions of Southeast Asian nations like Cambodia, Thailand, and Indonesia.
2. Traditional dance-dramas based on episodes from the Indian epics *Ramayana* and *Mahabharata* remain immensely popular in countries like Indonesia even today.
3. Magnificent Hindu and Buddhist temples dedicated to Lord Shiva, Lord Vishnu, and Buddha (such as Angkor Wat in Cambodia and Prambanan in Java) stand as eternal proof of this cultural exchange.

Q2.) The spread of Buddhism in China became easier.

1. In the 1st century CE, Emperor Ming of China officially invited Indian Buddhist monks Dharmaraksha and Kashyapa Matanga to the imperial capital.
2. These venerable monks, followed later by Kumarajiva and others, translated numerous canonical Buddhist scriptures into the Chinese language.
3. These translations enabled the Chinese populace and scholars to readily comprehend Buddhist philosophy, significantly accelerating the spread of Buddhism across China.

3. What would you do if you are encouraged in your favourite hobby?

When someone encourages me in my favourite hobby, it greatly strengthens my self-confidence and enthusiasm. I would dedicate disciplined time to practice it, seek mentorship to improve my skills, read reference materials to deepen my knowledge, and use my hobby constructively to express my creativity.

4. Describe a picture: A picture of the Gandhara style sculpture on a stupa in Hadda, Afghanistan is given in this chapter. Observe it and write about it:

1. The Gandhara style sculpture at Hadda, Afghanistan shows the remarkable fusion of classical Greek artistic styles with Indian Buddhist themes.
2. The facial features, natural curly locks of hair, and intricate realistic drapery folds of the monastic garments demonstrate profound Greco-Roman influence.
3. Despite the Greek physical aesthetics, the serene, meditative facial expression embodies the spiritual tranquility of ancient Indian Buddhist art.

5. Find out more about:

Q1.) The Gandhara style of art.

The Gandhara school of art flourished in the northwestern region of the Indian subcontinent (modern Pakistan and eastern Afghanistan) under the patronage of the Kushana rulers. It is characterized by the blending of Greek and Roman sculpting techniques with Buddhist devotional themes. Sculptors predominantly carved lifelike stone images of Gautam Buddha and Bodhisattvas with defined features, realistic folds of drapery, and graceful posture.

Q2.) The Silk Route.

The Silk Route was an ancient network of trans-Eurasian trade routes connecting China and India to the Mediterranean and Europe. Chinese silk, spices, and fine merchandise were transported westward along this route. Several vital trading junctions in northern India were directly linked to it. The Silk Route was also a major cultural conduit through which Buddhism spread from India to Central Asia and China, and along which celebrated Chinese pilgrim-scholars such as Fa-Hien and Yuan Chwang travelled to India.